



# Incident handler's journal

## Scenario

A small U.S. health care clinic specializing in delivering primary-care services experienced a security incident on a Tuesday morning, at approximately 9:00 a.m. Several employees reported that they were unable to use their computers to access files like medical records. Business operations shut down because employees were unable to access the files and software needed to do their job.

Additionally, employees also reported that a ransom note was displayed on their computers. The ransom note stated that all the company's files were encrypted by an organized group of unethical hackers who are known to target organizations in healthcare and transportation industries. In exchange for restoring access to the encrypted files, the ransom note demanded a large sum of money in exchange for the decryption key.

The attackers were able to gain access into the company's network by using targeted phishing emails, which were sent to several employees of the company. The phishing emails contained a malicious attachment that installed malware on the employee's computer once it was downloaded.

Once the attackers gained access, they deployed their ransomware, which encrypted critical files. The company was unable to access critical patient data, causing major disruptions in their business operations. The company was forced to shut down their computer systems and contact several organizations to report the incident and receive technical assistance.

## Journal

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| <b>Date:</b><br>February 15th | <b>Entry:</b><br>#150226001 – Ransomware at U.S clinic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Description</b>            | A small U.S healthcare clinic experienced a security incident that rendered their computers unable to access files and data. The attack was orchestrated by malicious attackers caused by targeted phishing emails (the attached file is a malicious malware and will infect the computer/s once downloaded). The company cannot access critical data for their patients and attackers demanded a payment for the ransomware breach to allow access. This resulted in the company to shut down their computer systems and requested the assistance from organizations                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Tool(s) used</b>           | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>The 5 W's</b>              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>● The individuals that were affected are healthcare employees</li> <li>● The healthcare clinic got a ransomware breach and demanded a large sum of payment to allow access to critical patient data.</li> <li>● The security incident occurred on Tuesday and approximately 9:00 AM.</li> <li>● The location was in United States.</li> <li>● The reason for the security incident was that the threat actors utilized targeted phishing emails (these contain with files filled with malware) and sent to healthcare employees. Once the employees, even only one, downloaded the content. The attacker gained access and encrypted the files.</li> </ul> |
| <b>Additional notes</b>       | The healthcare must have an IT department to handle this incident from ever happening. Either the department is non-existent (since it is a small clinic) or even if there is one, the budget of campaigns, workshops, and programs focused on security awareness, are not prioritized or non-existent.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |